

Make Sure Your Wife's Routines and Care Details Reach the New Team

Four prompts to gather what the new caregivers must know, write her routines in her own terms, separate sent from received, and leave with a receipt log.

Where you are

Your wife has moved, or a new caregiver has taken over at home. You sent a folder and told two people about her mornings. You're not sure anyone read the folder, and this morning went badly.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You can list what the receiving team needs, show what they've confirmed and what they haven't, and name who is sorting out each piece that doesn't match.

A one-page handoff record: What the team must know, Sent and to whom, Receipt confirmed, Conflicting or unclear items, and Who is following up.

Before you start

- Whatever you sent or handed over, and roughly when.
- Your own description of her day: how she wakes, what she eats, what calms her, what upsets her.
- Any instruction you've seen the new team follow that doesn't match what you know. You don't need all of this to begin.

PROMPT 1

Write down what only you know about her

WHY THIS MATTERS

The medical chart travels. The fact that she likes the curtains open and panics if the radio is off does not, unless you write it. These details are what make the first weeks go well or badly.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your notes on how her days actually go and what matters to her.

COPY THIS PROMPT

My wife has recently moved to a new care arrangement and the people caring for her do not know her yet. Here is how her days actually go and what matters to her, in my own words:

[PASTE YOUR NOTES]

Organize this into an About Her page a busy caregiver could read in three minutes, with headings: MORNINGS, MEALS, REST AND NIGHT, WHAT HELPS WHEN SHE IS UPSET, WHAT SHE ENJOYS, and THINGS THAT ARE EASY TO GET WRONG. Keep my wording where you can. Leave out medications and medical instructions entirely; those come from her clinicians, not from this page. Then list anything about her routine I seem to have skipped.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

The things you do automatically that nobody wrote down until now.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Read it to someone who knows her and add what they'd correct.

PROMPT 2

List what the receiving team must have

WHY THIS MATTERS

Some of what you know came from her doctor. Some came from the last aide. Some you worked out yourself. The team needs to know which is which, and so do you.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

A list of what you think they need, with where each item came from.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Here is what I believe the people now caring for my wife need to know or have from us, and where each piece comes from:

[PASTE YOUR LIST, INCLUDING THE SOURCE OF EACH ITEM]

Sort it into a table: ITEM, SOURCE (for example her doctor, the pharmacy, the previous caregiver, the family), and TYPE (CLINICAL, PRACTICAL, or PERSONAL). Flag any CLINICAL item where I am the only source, because a care instruction from memory should be confirmed with the clinician who gave it. Then list what a receiving caregiver commonly needs that is missing from my list, as questions for me, not as content. Do not write or adjust any care instruction.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Clinical items with 'family' as the only source. Those need the clinician's version.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask the pharmacy or doctor's office for a current copy of anything flagged.

PROMPT 3

Separate what was sent from what was received

WHY THIS MATTERS

An email that nobody opened has not arrived. When the team does something different from what you sent, that is information, not an accusation. It tells you where to look.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

What you sent, when, to whom, and anything you've seen that doesn't match.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Here is what we sent or handed to my wife's new care team, when, and to whom, plus anything I've seen them do that doesn't match what we sent:

[PASTE YOUR NOTES]

Build a receipt table with columns: ITEM, SENT (DATE, HOW, TO WHOM), RECEIPT CONFIRMED BY A NAMED PERSON (YES or NO), and MATCHES WHAT THEY'RE DOING (YES, NO, or NOT SURE). Treat 'I emailed it' as sent, not received. Under the table, list every row with NO or NOT SURE as a short question for the receiving contact. Then draft a brief message asking them to name one person who will confirm what they have on file. Do not decide which version of a conflicting instruction is right.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Rows marked sent but not confirmed, and anything the team does differently from what you sent.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Send the message. Write the named contact's name at the top of your notes.

PROMPT 4

Assemble the handoff record

WHY THIS MATTERS

You now have three tables and a page about her. The record pulls them into one sheet that shows what is settled and what still has no owner.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The results of the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

Here is everything I have about getting my wife's care information to her new team:

[PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 TO 3]

Make a one-page handoff record with five headings: WHAT THE TEAM MUST KNOW, SENT AND TO WHOM, RECEIPT CONFIRMED, CONFLICTING OR UNCLEAR ITEMS, and WHO IS FOLLOWING UP. Under the last heading, put a name beside each unclear item, or write NEEDS AN OWNER if I didn't give one. Nothing counts as done unless a named person confirmed it. Do not settle any conflict yourself, and do not add medical content.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A short list of NEEDS AN OWNER lines. Those are your next conversations.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Give each NEEDS AN OWNER item to someone, then keep the page for the next step.

What travels with her should be written down once.

A handoff record shows what reached the new team. The care interview captures your wife's situation in one Family Care Profile, a single current document you can share and update instead of a folder and a phone call.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›